
the dot
'What Is International Dot Day?'
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International Dot Day

In 2009, a teacher named Terry Shay shared the book ‘The Dot’ with his class.

‘The Dot’ is an inspiring story of a young girl named Vashti, who believes that she is not very good at drawing. A caring teacher helps Vashti become confident enough to ‘make her mark’ and develop her drawing skills bit by bit.

Vashti believes in herself more and even helps another child to ‘make his mark’ at the end of the story.



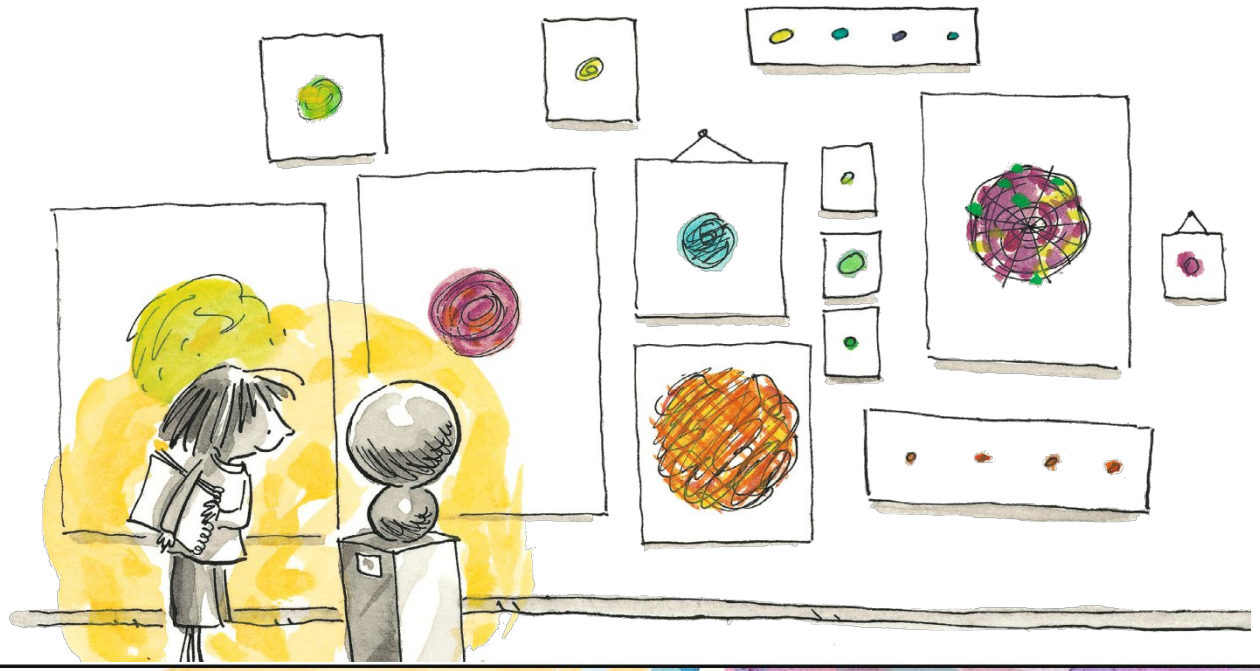
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International Dot Day

Terry Shay created International Dot Day to encourage children and adults to continue their discovery of the power of positivity, creativity and ‘making their mark’, just like Vashti in the book.

International Dot Day is now an annual event that is celebrated in many countries across the globe on 15th September.



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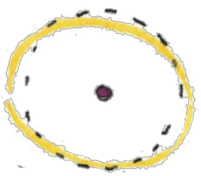
Peter H. Reynolds

The author of 'The Dot', Peter H. Reynolds, regularly shares inspiring quotes to spread a positive message about the importance of teamwork and creativity.

"Pick up that pencil. Today is a good day to create."

"There is more good than bad in this world. More light than darkness and we can make more light – together."

"... think of each day as a new day… a blank page… a chance to make it the best day yet."



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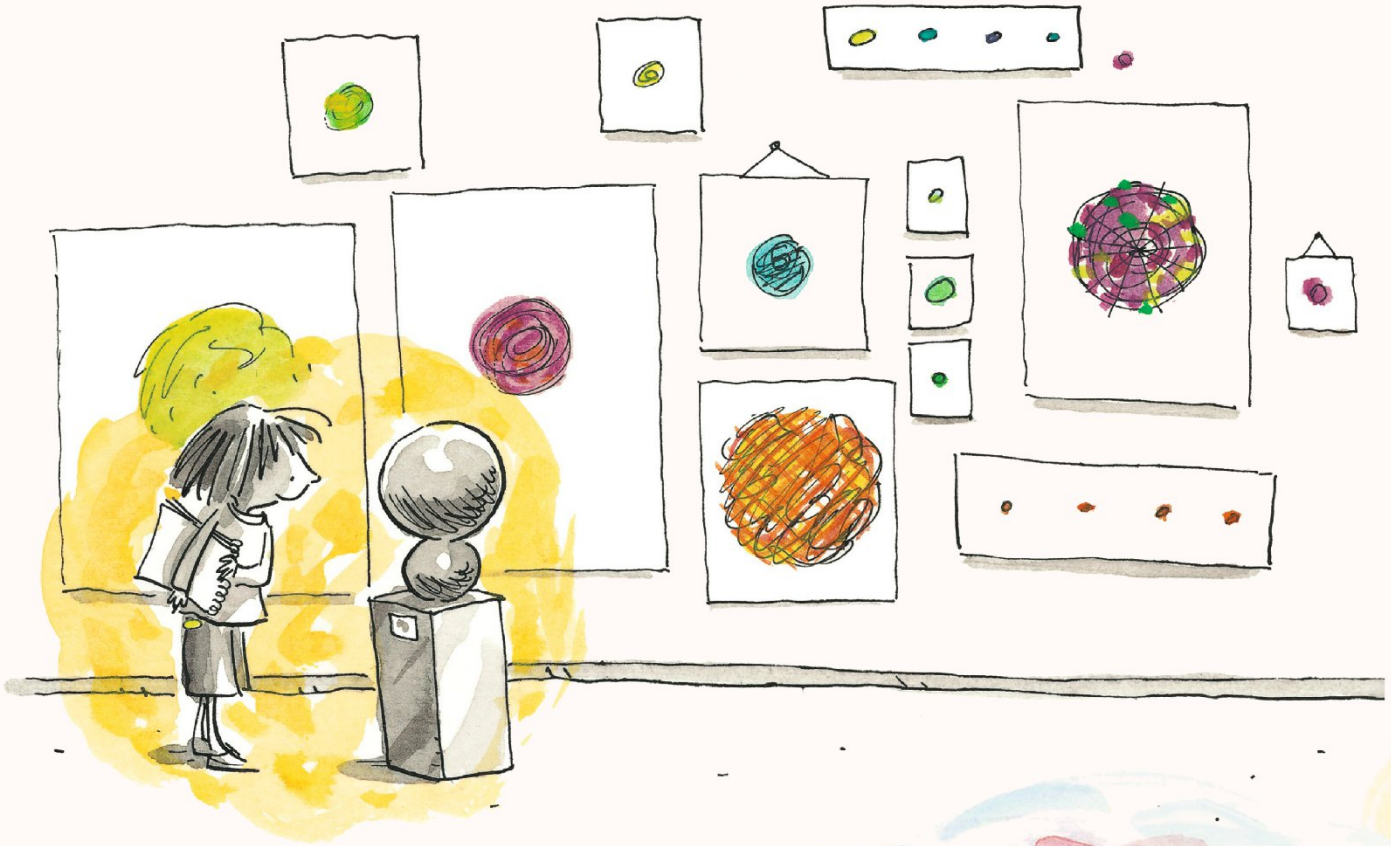
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What Can You Do to Celebrate International Dot Day?

There are many ways that you can be involved with International Dot Day:

- Read ‘The Dot’ and share a time when someone important has helped you to be confident and creative.
- Create a piece of artwork starting from a dot – perhaps you could put it in a beautiful frame like Vashti! You might want to use different materials, such as paints, fabric or paper.
- Share a goal you have achieved that you are proud of – could you encourage and help others to achieve their goals? Create a plan for how you might do this.
- Discuss what ‘making your mark’ means to you – how can you ‘make your mark’ on the world?

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